



Gutter Cleaning & Gutter Guard Installation

Professional Process Guide

Nobody walks on your roof. Every downspout flushed. Camera confirmed clear.

High-Reach Ground Vacuum + Pole Camera Verification + Downspout Flush + Mesh, Micro-Mesh & Surface Tension Guards

PREPARED EXCLUSIVELY FOR

Client Name _____

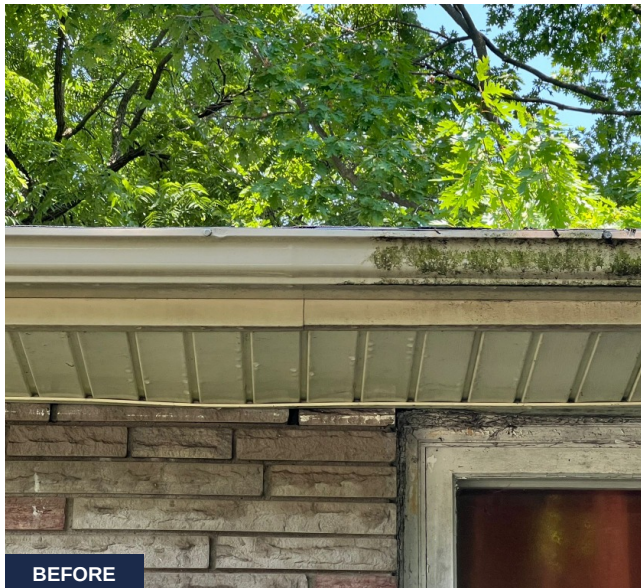
Property Address _____

Phone _____

Email _____

What's Included

Full gutter clear-out using a high-reach vacuum operated from the ground, so nobody walks on your roof and no ladder leans against your eavestrough. Every downspout is flushed and confirmed flowing, and a pole camera verifies every section is clear before we leave. Debris is bagged and removed from site, gutter faces are checked for damage, and we report back to you with photos. Gutter guard installation available in mesh, micro-mesh and solid surface tension styles.



Oakridge, London. Eavestroughs packed with leaves and organic debris, cleared and flushed from the ground.

Why This Process Matters

A Blocked Gutter Is a Foundation Problem in Slow Motion

A gutter is not a decorative trim piece. It is the system that moves several thousand litres of roof water per storm away from your foundation. When it blocks, that water goes over the edge and lands in a concentrated line right against the wall of your house. In London Ontario that means saturated foundation soil, hydrostatic pressure against the basement wall, and eventually seepage. Water sitting in a blocked gutter through a freeze thaw cycle also expands, which is what pulls the hangers loose and tears the eavestrough away from the fascia.

There is a second cost that is easy to miss. Debris sitting in a gutter stays wet, and wet organic material against wooden fascia rots it from the back where you cannot see it. By the time the paint bubbles on the front, the board behind it is often gone. Cleaning gutters twice a year is one of the cheapest pieces of preventive maintenance a homeowner can buy.

Why We Work From the Ground

Most gutter companies put a person on a ladder or on your roof. Both cause problems. A ladder resting against the eavestrough dents the front lip and bends the hangers, which is the reason so many gutters sag in exactly the spots where ladders get placed. Walking on a roof scuffs granules off asphalt shingles and shortens their life, particularly on hot days when the shingles are soft. Working from the ground with a high-reach vacuum eliminates both, and it eliminates the fall risk from your property entirely.

The Complete Package

- Full eavestrough clear-out using a high-reach vacuum operated entirely from ground level
- Every downspout flushed and confirmed flowing, including underground and buried extensions
- Pole camera verification of every section before we leave, with photos sent to you
- Hangers, spikes, seams, end caps and slope checked and reported on
- Debris bagged and removed from site, never left in your beds or on the lawn
- Gutter face and downspout exterior wash available as an add-on
- Gutter guard installation in mesh, micro-mesh or solid surface tension styles

Pricing & Timeline

Gutter work is quoted by linear footage, storey height, roof pitch and how much debris has built up. We confirm exact scope during a free walkthrough. The ranges below are what most London area homes fall into so you have a realistic starting point.

Bungalow gutter clean, single storey	From \$150
Two storey home gutter clean	From \$250
Gutter face and downspout exterior wash	From \$1.50 / linear ft
Mesh gutter guard, supplied and installed	From \$8 / linear ft
Micro-mesh gutter guard, supplied and installed	From \$12 / linear ft

Heavy accumulation, steep pitch, three storey elevations, buried downspout lines and homes under mature tree cover can move the price. Booking gutter cleaning alongside a house soft wash or window cleaning is always cheaper than two separate visits, since setup and staging happen once.

Typical Timeline

A standard bungalow is 90 minutes to two hours. A two storey home is two to four hours depending on linear footage and debris volume. Guard installation is usually a same day job on an average residential home, and we always clean the gutters fully before any guard goes on. You do not need to be home for either.

When Should You Book?

SITUATION	WHAT WE RECOMMEND
Late fall, after the leaves have finished dropping.	The single most important clean of the year. Book it before the first freeze.
Spring, after seed pods, blossoms and maple keys have come down.	Second most important. Seed pods block downspouts faster than leaves do.
Water pouring over the edge during rain, or staining down the siding.	Book now. This is an active blockage, not a maintenance question.
You are on the ladder twice a year and would rather not be.	Gutter guards. Ask us which style suits your roof pitch and tree cover.

Step by Step Process

Below is exactly what happens on a Core Exteriors gutter service, from the first walkthrough to the photo report we send

PHASE 1

Assessment & System Inspection

We check the system before we clear it, because a blocked gutter often hides a second problem underneath.

1.1 Full Perimeter Walk

We walk the complete perimeter of the house and note debris level in each run, visible overflow staining on the siding or fascia, plant growth in the trough, and any section visibly sagging or pulling away from the fascia board.

1.2 Downspout & Discharge Mapping

Every downspout is located and its discharge point traced. Underground and buried lines are identified now, because a downspout that drains into a blocked buried line will back up again within one storm no matter how clean the trough above it is.

1.3 Hanger, Spike & Seam Check

Hangers, spikes, seams and end caps are inspected for movement and separation. The weight of wet debris is what pulls these loose, so this is exactly the moment to catch it.

1.4 Slope & Standing Water Check

We check that each run actually falls toward its downspout. Standing water in a clean gutter means the slope is wrong or a hanger has dropped, and that is a repair, not a cleaning issue. We tell you either way.

1.5 Before Photo Documentation

Pole camera photos of every run before we start. These go in your report alongside the after photos so you can see exactly

PHASE 2

Site Protection & Equipment Staging

Debris comes out of the gutter and off the property, not into your garden beds.

2.1 Landscape & Hardscape Protection

Garden beds, shrubs, walkways and patios directly beneath the work area are covered where needed so nothing lands in them.

2.2 Vacuum & Pole Assembly

The high-reach vacuum system is staged and carbon poles are assembled to the height needed for the tallest elevation. Reach is confirmed to every run before we start.

2.3 Containment Setup

Collection bags and containment are set up at the vacuum so debris is captured as it comes out rather than being dropped and picked up afterward.

PHASE 3

Ground Level Vacuum Clear-Out

Nobody on your roof. Nothing leaning against your eavestrough.

3.1 How the System Works

A high-reach vacuum on carbon fibre poles extends from the ground into the trough and pulls debris directly into a containment bag. There is no ladder against the gutter face, no weight on the hangers, and nobody walking on your shingles.

3.2 Systematic Run Coverage

We work each run methodically from the far end toward the downspout so material moves in one direction and nothing gets pushed into a corner or packed into an outlet.

3.3 Compacted Debris Handling

Debris that has been sitting long enough to compact into a solid mat does not vacuum out in one pass. These sections get worked and cleared properly rather than partially, because a half cleared gutter blocks again with the first heavy rain.

3.4 Roof Valleys & Overhangs

Loose debris sitting in roof valleys and along the drip edge directly above the gutter is cleared as well. Leaving it there means it

PHASE 4

Downspout Flush & Flow Verification

A clean trough with a blocked downspout is not a finished job. This is the step that gets skipped most often.

4.1 Outlet Clearing

The outlet where the trough meets the downspout is the narrowest point in the entire system and where blockages form first. Each outlet is cleared directly rather than assumed clear because the trough above it looks clean.

4.2 Full Downspout Flush

Every downspout is flushed with water and watched at the discharge point to confirm full flow. If the water backs up, the line is blocked somewhere in the run and we locate it.

4.3 Blockage Clearing

Blockages found in the downspout are cleared with rods and flushing. Elbows and the transition at grade are the two most common failure points and both get checked directly.

4.4 Underground Line Verification

Where downspouts feed into a buried line we confirm the water is actually reaching the discharge point. A buried line that has collapsed or filled with roots will back water up into the gutter, and it is invisible from the ground unless you check.

PHASE 5

Camera Verification & Photo Report

You should not have to take our word for it, and you should not have to climb a ladder to check.

5.1 Pole Camera Inspection

A pole camera runs the full length of every section after cleaning. Every run is confirmed clear visually, not assumed clear because the vacuum stopped pulling material.

5.2 Before & After Photo Report

You receive before and after photos of every run. If you are not home when we work, this is your proof the job was done properly and done everywhere.

5.3 Condition Report

Anything we found gets reported: loose hangers, separated seams, damaged end caps, rust through, sagging sections, incorrect slope, rotting fascia behind the trough, or a buried line that is not flowing. We tell you what needs attention and what

PHASE 6

Cleanup & Walkthrough

The property is left the way we found it, minus the debris.

6.1 Debris Removal From Site

All collected debris is bagged and hauled away. We do not leave it in your green bin, in your beds, or in a pile at the side of the house.

6.2 Ground Level Rinse

Any material that landed on walkways, patios or the driveway during the work is rinsed off before we leave.

6.3 Client Walkthrough & Sign Off

We walk the property with you, review the photo report and explain anything we flagged. You sign off before we close the job file.

A Note on Timing

The best time to book a fall gutter clean is after the leaves have finished dropping but before the first hard freeze. Book too early and the trees refill the gutter behind you. Book too late and the debris freezes into a solid block, which is far harder to remove and far more likely to have already caused an ice dam. In London that window is usually the first three weeks of November, and it books up quickly.

Gutter Guards

Gutter guards reduce how often the system needs clearing and how much ends up in the trough. No guard on the market eliminates maintenance entirely, and any company that tells you otherwise is selling you something. What a good guard does is turn a twice yearly clean-out into an occasional inspection, and it stops the heavy blockages that cause overflow and ice damming.

The Three Styles We Install

MESH

An aluminium or steel mesh screen fitted over the trough. Keeps out leaves and larger debris while letting water through freely. The most cost effective option and a good fit for properties with broadleaf trees like maple and oak. Fine material such as shingle grit and pine pollen can still pass through, so an occasional flush is still worth doing.

MICRO-MESH

A much finer stainless steel mesh over a rigid frame. This is the option for properties with pine, cedar, spruce or birch, because pine needles and seed pods walk straight through standard mesh and are the single most common cause of a blocked downspout in London. Micro-mesh stops essentially everything organic. Higher cost, and the best long term performer.

SOLID SURFACE TENSION

A solid cover that uses surface tension to curl water around the nose of the guard and into the trough while debris carries over the edge and falls to the ground. Works very well on steeper roof pitches. Less effective on low pitch roofs and in very heavy downpours, where water can overshoot. Roof pitch determines whether this is the right choice, which is why we assess before recommending it.

Choosing the Right Guard

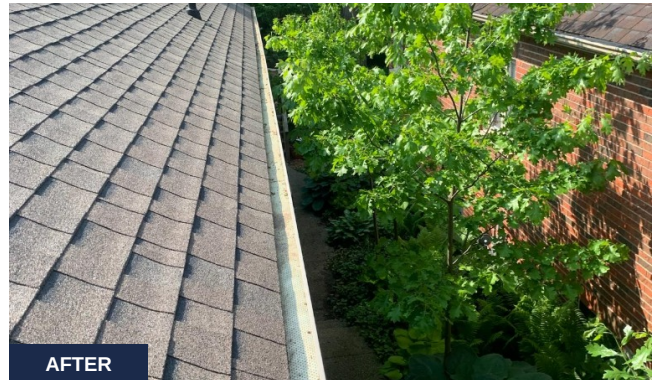
YOUR PROPERTY	WHAT WE WOULD RECOMMEND
Maple, oak and other broadleaf trees over the house.	Mesh. Handles leaf load well at the best price point.
Pine, cedar, spruce or birch anywhere near the roof line.	Micro-mesh. Needles pass straight through standard mesh.
Steep roof pitch and you want the least visible option.	Solid surface tension. Works with the pitch you already have.
Low pitch roof, or you get heavy downpours off a large roof area.	Mesh or micro-mesh. Surface tension can overshoot on low pitch.

Manufacturer Warranty Options

Lifetime manufacturer backed products are available on request. We will always tell you honestly whether the upgrade is worth it for your specific roof and tree cover rather than defaulting you to the most expensive option.

Before & After

Real Core Exteriors gutter jobs across London and surrounding areas.



London. Eavestrough packed solid with leaves and organic debris, cleared and confirmed flowing.



Oakridge, London. Full clear-out and downspout flush, verified with a pole camera.



Wortley Village, London. Mature tree cover means twice yearly service is the right interval here.

Questions Homeowners Ask Us

How often do gutters actually need cleaning?

Twice a year for most London homes, spring and late fall. Once a year is enough if you have no trees overhanging the roof. Properties under mature maples, oaks or pines often need three visits, because a single heavy drop can fill a trough completely.

Do you walk on my roof or lean a ladder on my gutters?

Neither. Everything is done with a high-reach vacuum on carbon fibre poles operated from the ground. That protects your shingles from granule loss and your eavestrough from the dents and bent hangers that ladders cause, and it removes the fall risk from your property.

How do I know the job was actually done if I am not home?

You get a photo report. A pole camera runs every section after cleaning and you receive before and after photos of each run, plus a note on anything we found. This is standard on every job, not an extra.

Will gutter guards mean I never have to clean them again?

No, and we will not tell you they will. Guards dramatically reduce how much gets into the trough and how often it needs clearing, and they stop the heavy blockages that cause overflow and ice dams. They still need an occasional inspection and flush, particularly micro-mesh which can accumulate fine grit on the surface over several years.

Are gutter guards worth the money?

It depends on your trees and how you feel about ladders. If you are paying for two cleans a year under heavy tree cover, guards usually pay for themselves in four to six years and remove the twice yearly hassle. If you have almost no tree cover and book once a year, the case is much weaker. We will tell you which situation you are in.

Water is pouring over the front of my gutter during rain. What causes that?

Usually a blocked outlet or downspout rather than a full trough. Sometimes it is slope, where the run is not falling toward the downspout so water pools and spills at the low point. Occasionally it is simply undersized gutters for the roof area. We diagnose which one it is during the assessment rather than just clearing it and hoping.

What is an ice dam and are gutters the cause?

An ice dam forms when heat escaping through the roof melts snow, the water runs down to the cold overhang and refreezes, building a ridge of ice that backs water up under the shingles. Blocked gutters make it considerably worse because there is nowhere for the meltwater to go. Clean gutters help, but the underlying fix is attic insulation and ventilation.

Can you fix loose or sagging gutters while you are here?

Minor work such as re-securing loose hangers and spikes we can usually handle on the same visit. Separated seams, rust through, replacement sections and slope corrections are quoted separately. We flag everything we find in the report so you can decide.

Do you clean the outside of the gutters too?

That is a separate add-on. The white oxidised streaking on eavestrough faces, sometimes called tiger striping, needs a dedicated gutter brightener and hand agitation. Rinsing does not touch it. It is commonly booked alongside a house soft wash.

Why are you cheaper than the franchise that quoted me?

We are fully independent, so we pay no franchise royalties or corporate marketing levies. That is roughly a 20 percent difference and it comes off your price, not out of the work. We carry \$5M in liability insurance and are fully WSIB compliant.

Guarantee & Next Steps

The Job-Complete Guarantee

We do not leave the site until you are 100 percent satisfied with the work. If a downspout backs up within 30 days of our visit because of something we should have cleared, we come back and fix it at no charge.

Equipment We Use

High-reach gutter vacuum system operated entirely from ground level on carbon fibre poles, pole camera for pre and post inspection, downspout rods and flushing equipment, and manufacturer backed mesh, micro-mesh and solid surface tension guard products. No ladders against your eavestrough and nobody on your roof.

Aftercare Essentials

- Book spring and late fall. In London the fall window is usually the first three weeks of November.
- Trim branches back off the roof line. It is the cheapest way to reduce how fast gutters fill.
- Check downspout discharge points after heavy rain. Water should be moving well away from the foundation.
- Add downspout extensions if water is discharging within two feet of the foundation wall.
- If you see water going over the front edge during rain, call us. That is an active blockage.

Credentials

- \$5 Million commercial general liability insurance
- Fully WSIB compliant with clearance certificate available on request
- Working at Heights certified crew for elevated work
- HST registered, London Ontario based, operating since 2022
- Serving London. St. Thomas. Strathroy. Dorchester and surrounding communities

Ready to Book Your Free Walkthrough?

We will assess the system, map the downspouts, tell you whether guards make sense for your trees and roof pitch, and put it in writing before any work begins. No obligation and no pressure to book on the spot.

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